

Corn Disease: Common Rust

Metadata

Crop: Corn
Disease: Common Rust
Scientific Name: *Puccinia sorghi*
Pathogen: Fungus
Source: TNAU, ICAR

Overview

Common Rust is a fungal disease causing orange pustules on maize leaves, reducing photosynthesis.

Symptoms

Early: Small orange spots.
Advanced: Raised pustules on both leaf surfaces.

Similar Diseases

Gray Leaf Spot: flat lesions.
Northern Leaf Blight: elongated lesions.

Favorable Conditions

Cool temperatures (16–25°C), high humidity.

Transmission

Airborne spores spread via wind.

Management

Cultural: Resistant hybrids, sanitation.
Chemical: Mancozeb, propiconazole.

Prevention

Early sowing, monitoring fields.

Severity

Mild: few pustules.

Severe: widespread infection reducing yield.

Recommended Action

Apply fungicides early and use resistant varieties.

Source

TNAU: <https://agritech.tnau.ac.in>

ICAR: <https://icar.org.in>